

English Extension 11–12 (2024)

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Table of contents

Table of contents	4
English Extension 11–12 (2024)	5
Implementation from 2026	5
Overview	5
Syllabus overview	5
Course description	7
Rationale	11
Rationale for English in Stage 6 curriculum	11
Rationale for English Extension 1	11
Rationale for English Extension 2	11
Aim	13
Table of outcomes	14
Outcomes and content for Year 11	15
Texts, culture and value	15
Outcomes and content for Year 12 – Extension 1	17
Literary worlds.....	17
Outcomes and content for Year 12 – Extension 2	19
Author and authority	19
Major work.....	21

English Extension 11–12 (2024)

Implementation from 2026

The new English Extension 11–12 Syllabus (2024) is to be implemented from 2026 and will replace the [English Extension Stage 6 Syllabus \(2017\)](#).

2026, Term 1

- Start teaching the new syllabus for Year 11
- Start implementing the new Year 11 school-based assessment requirements
- Continue to teach the [English Extension Stage 6 Syllabus \(2017\)](#) for Year 12

2026, Term 4

- Start teaching the new syllabus for Year 12
- Start implementing the new Year 12 school-based assessment requirements

2027

- First HSC examination for the new syllabus

Overview

Syllabus overview

Organisation of English Extension 11–12

The organisation of focus areas, outcomes and content for English Extension 11–12 highlights the interdependence of knowledge, understanding and skills in the subject, and the recursive way in which they are developed.

Students develop knowledge, understanding and skills through the following focus areas:

English Extension Year 11

- Texts, culture and value (and the Related research project)

English Extension 1 Year 12

- Literary worlds (including ONE elective option)

English Extension 2 Year 12

- Author and authority
- Major work

Figure 1 shows the organisation of English Extension 11–12.

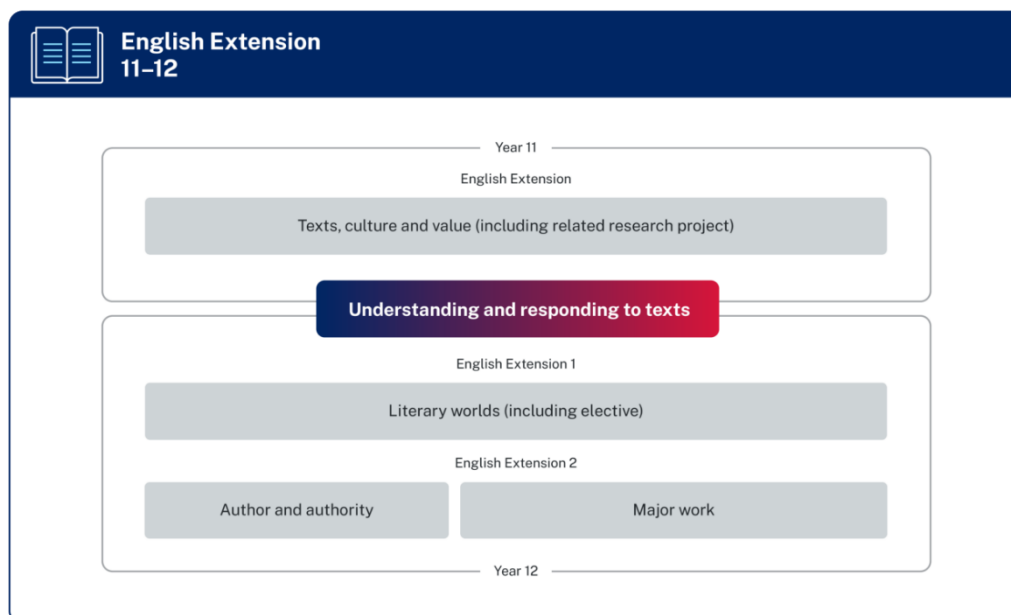


Figure 1: The organisation of English Extension 11–12

Image long description: The Year 11 focus area appears in a box under the heading ‘English Extension’ at the top of the diagram, surrounded by a line labelled ‘Year 11’. The focus area is: Texts, culture and value (including related research project). The Year 12 focus areas are split into ‘English Extension 1’ and ‘English Extension 2’. These focus areas are surrounded by a line labelled ‘Year 12’. The English Extension 1 focus area is: Literary worlds (including elective). The English Extension 2 focus areas are: Author and authority; and Major work. The lines surrounding the Year 11 and 12 focus areas cross through a box in the centre of the diagram, which is titled ‘Understanding and responding to texts’.

Protocols for collaborating with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Communities

NESA is committed to working in partnership with Aboriginal Communities and supporting teachers, schools and schooling sectors to improve educational outcomes for young people.

It is important to respect appropriate ways of interacting with Aboriginal Communities and Cultural material when teachers plan, program and implement learning experiences that focus on Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Priorities.

Indigenous Cultural and Intellectual Property (ICIP) protocols need to be followed. Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples’ ICIP protocols include Cultural Knowledges, Cultural Expression and Cultural Property and documentation of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples’ Identities and lived experiences. It is important to recognise the diversity and complexity of different Cultural groups in NSW, as protocols may differ between local Aboriginal Communities.

Teachers should work in partnership with Elders, parents, Community members, Cultural Knowledge Holders, or a local, regional or state Aboriginal Education Consultative Group. It is important to respect Elders and the roles of men and women. Local Aboriginal Peoples should be invited to share their Cultural Knowledges with students and staff when engaging with Aboriginal histories and Cultural Practices.

Course description

English Extension Year 11 and English Extension 1 Year 12 provide students with the opportunity to extend their use of language and self-expression in creative and critical ways. Students engage with increasingly complex concepts through a broad range of literature from different contexts. Through this, they refine their understanding and appreciation of the significance of texts, and the way that literature shapes and reflects the world.

English Extension 2 Year 12 extends students' conceptual understanding of the ways literature is read and written through their consideration of authorship and their authorial role. Students develop their understanding of the composition process to create a substantial and original Major work

What students learn

Through the study of English Extension, students:

- learn to use clear written and verbal communication for a range of purposes and audiences
- interpret and evaluate information and arguments for clarity, precision and effectiveness
- make inferences about intention and meaning of language based on contextual clues
- explore using verbal and written language to confidently express personal experiences and opinions, and reflect on development of knowledge and skills as independent learners.

Course structure and requirements

English Extension Year 11 course structure and requirements

English Extension Year 11 course (60 hours)	Indicative hours
Texts, culture and value	40
Related research project (This project may be undertaken concurrently)	20

For the English Extension Year 11 course, students are required to:

- complete 60 indicative hours
- undertake the study of Texts, culture and value
- undertake the Related research project.

Text requirements

Teachers prescribe ONE text from the past and its manifestations in one or more recent contexts.

Students select ONE text and its manifestations in one or more recent contexts. They research a range of texts as part of their Related research project.

Across Stage 6, the selection of texts should give students experience of:

- texts that are widely regarded as quality literature
- a range of Australian texts
- a range of texts authored by Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander Peoples
- a range of types of texts that includes prose fiction, drama, poetry, nonfiction, film, media, multimedia and digital texts
- integrated modes of reading, writing, listening, speaking, viewing and representing, where appropriate.

English Extension 1 Year 12 course structure and requirements

English Extension 1 Year 12 course (60 hours)	Indicative hours
Literary worlds (including ONE elective option)	60

For the English Extension 1 Year 12 course, students are required to:

- complete the English Extension Year 11 course as a prerequisite
- complete 60 indicative hours
- undertake the study of ONE elective option.

Text requirements

Students are required to study THREE prescribed texts in ONE elective. At least TWO of these texts are required to be extended print texts, which may include poetry.

Students are also required to study ONE related text for the elective.

English Extension 2 Year 12 course structure and requirements

English Extension 2 Year 12 course (60 hours)	Indicative hours
Author and authority	20
Major work	40

For the English Extension 2 Year 12 course, students are required to:

- be undertaking study of the English Extension 1 Year 12 course
- complete 60 indicative hours
- undertake Author and authority concurrently, including ONE author study
- complete a Major work
- document the development of their Major work in a Major work journal.

Major work journal

The Major work journal is a record of all stages of the composition process. This could include the documentation of research and analysis, as well as critical, imaginative and speculative reflections. Students use the journal to record the recursive and iterative creative process.

Text requirements

As part of Author and authority and the associated author study, students undertake an extensive, independent investigation involving a range of complex texts.

For the Major work the selection of texts will depend on the form of the Major work and be appropriate to the purpose, audience and context of the composition.

The [HSC English prescriptions 2027–2030](#) provides essential information for HSC study for all English 11–12 courses.

Safety and risk management

Schools are required to ensure they follow [safety and risk management](#) in delivering the *English Extension 11–12 Syllabus*.

Texts authored by Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander Peoples

Across Stage 6, the study of a range of texts authored by Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander Peoples should consider:

- the artistic and Cultural value of these texts, including ideas, arguments and representations of identity, histories and Cultures
- how Country/Place, Community and lived experiences shape the perspectives of Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander Storytellers and audiences
- ethical responsibilities surrounding Indigenous Cultural and Intellectual Property (ICIP) in the production of texts
- how Storytelling, Aboriginal Languages and Aboriginal English are expressions of Culture, identity and Customary practices
- how the modes of these texts may recognise and contribute to Cultural conventions or practices of oral Storytelling
- how Cultural symbolism, imagery, allusion and irony are used to shape meaning
- how personal values and perspectives are broadened and reconsidered through engagement with these texts
- texts that originate from a range of diverse Communities.

Course enrolment details

English Extension 1 Year 11

- Course number: 11150
- Course hours: 60
- Course units: 1
- Enrolment type: Elective
- Endorsement type: Board developed

Exclusions

- English EAL/D (Year 11, 2 units): 11165
- English Standard (Year 11, 2 units): 11130
- English Studies (Year 11, 2 units): 11127
- English Life Skills (Year 11, 2 units): 17640

Prerequisites

- Nil

Corequisites

- English Advanced (Year 11, 2 units): 11140

English Extension 1 Year 12

- Course number: 15160
- Course hours: 60
- Course units: 1
- Enrolment type: Elective
- Endorsement type: Board developed

Exclusions

- English EAL/D (Year 12, 2 units): 15155
- English Standard (Year 12, 2 units): 15130

- English Studies (Year 12, 2 units): 15127
- English Studies (Examination) (Year 12, 2 units): 15128
- English Life Skills (Year 12, 2 units): 17640

Prerequisites

- English Advanced (Year 11, 2 units): 11140
- English Extension (Year 11, 1 unit): 11150

Corequisites

- English Advanced (Year 12, 2 units): 15140

English Extension 2 Year 12

- Course number: 15173
- Course hours: 60
- Course units: 1
- Enrolment type: Elective
- Endorsement type: Board developed

Exclusions

- English EAL/D (Year 12, 2 units): 15155
- English Standard (Year 12, 2 units): 15130
- English Studies (Year 12, 2 units): 15127
- English Studies (Examination) (Year 12, 2 units): 15128
- English Life Skills (Year 12, 2 units): 17640

Prerequisites

- English Advanced (Year 11, 2 units): 11140
- English Extension (Year 11, 1 unit): 11150

Corequisites

- English Advanced (Year 12, 2 units): 15140
- English Extension 1 (Year 12, 1 unit): 15160

HSC information

Information about [curriculum requirements](#) for the HSC are available on [Assessment Certification Examination \(ACE\)](#).

Rationale

Rationale for English in Stage 6 curriculum

In acknowledgement of its role as the national language, English is a mandatory subject from Kindergarten to Year 12 in the NSW curriculum. Knowledge, understanding and skills acquired in English are central to students' learning and development.

Language and text shape understanding of individuals and the world. Language allows students to relate to others, and contributes to their intellectual, social and emotional development. In English K–12, students study language in its various textual forms, with increasing complexity, to understand how meaning is shaped, conveyed, interpreted and reflected.

Students engage with literature from Australia and across the world, and develop an understanding of the diversity of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples and the interconnections of Country/Place, Culture and Community. Texts communicate in distinctive ways and are shaped by experiences, knowledge and cultures. By exploring past and contemporary texts with a range of cultural and social perspectives, students broaden their experiences and become empowered in their identities, values and ethics.

Through interrelated practices and experiences in understanding and creating texts, students explore the power, purpose, value and art of English. These support students to become literate and confident communicators, critical and imaginative thinkers, and informed and active participants in society.

The study of English in this syllabus is founded on the belief that language learning is recursive and develops through ever-widening contexts. Students learn English through explicit teaching of language and literacy, and through their engagement with a range of purposeful and increasingly demanding textual experiences.

Rationale for English Extension 1

The *English Extension 1 Syllabus* provides students who undertake English Advanced with the opportunity to extend their use of language and self-expression in critical and creative ways. Through engaging with increasingly complex concepts from a range of literary contexts, students refine their understanding and appreciation of literature as the expression and construction of culture.

Students independently pursue areas of interest with complex texts that challenge them to think critically and creatively about the way literature shapes and reflects the world. They learn to use research methodology to undertake investigation in English and develop extended compositions. Throughout the course, students explore and evaluate the meanings of texts and compare the value of texts. They investigate a range of conceptual contexts for the reading and composition of texts and explore and adopt a range of reading practices to develop awareness of the assumptions that guide interpretation and evaluation.

Rationale for English Extension 2

The *English Extension 2 Syllabus* enables students who are accomplished English users to extend their conceptual understanding of the ways literature is read and written in Extension 1 by encouraging them to consider their authorial role as they embark on their Major work. The focus areas provide students with a rich knowledge base to develop their skills in crafting language and refining their personal voice in critical and creative ways. Students create a substantial and original Major work that extends the knowledge, understanding and skills they have developed through

their study of English. Through the creative process, they independently pursue areas of interest, develop deep knowledge, and experiment with and manipulate language in their own extended compositions.

Through their engagement with a range of literary texts in Author and authority, students deepen their understanding of the innovative and insightful ways that experimentation with and exploration of form, style and media can express complex concepts and values. English Extension 2 invites the exploration and expression of human experiences, connects individuals to diverse perspectives, and enhances students' appreciation of literature and the aesthetics of language.

The Major work provides students with the opportunity to apply and extend the research skills developed in the English Extension Year 11 course to their own extensive investigation, and to develop autonomy and skills as a learner and author.

The course is designed for students with an interest in literature and a desire to pursue a specialised study of English.

Aim

The aim of English in Years 11 and 12 is to enable students to understand and use language effectively. Students have the opportunity to appreciate, reflect on and enjoy literature, and make meaning in ways that are imaginative, creative, interpretive, critical and powerful. Students value the English language in its various textual forms to become thoughtful and effective communicators in a diverse world.

Table of outcomes

Year 11	Year 12 – Extension 1	Year 12 – Extension 2
EE1-11-01 analyses the relationship between author, purpose, form, language, audience and context	EE1-12-01 evaluates the relationship between author, purpose, form, language, audience and context	EE2-12-01 evaluates the relationship between author, purpose, form, language, audience and context
EE1-11-02 analyses the ways meaning is made through an author's choice of textual form and language features	EE1-12-02 evaluates the ways meaning is made through an author's choice of textual form and language features	EE2-12-02 communicates insights and arguments about an area of literary inquiry or debate
EE1-11-03 analyses how texts are valued in a range of contexts and cultures for different purposes and audiences	EE1-12-03 analyses how texts are valued in a range of contexts and cultures for different purposes and audiences	EE2-12-03 evaluates the ways meaning and value can be assigned to authors and texts
EE1-11-04 uses independent inquiry skills to analyse key texts and compose texts	EE1-12-04 uses independent inquiry skills to analyse key texts and compose complex texts	EE2-12-04 creates sustained critical and creative texts supported by independent inquiry and scholarly readings
EE1-11-05 crafts extended texts that experiment with textual form and language features for a range of purposes and audiences	EE1-12-05 crafts extended texts that experiment with textual form and language features for a range of purposes and audiences	EE2-12-05 creates sustained texts that integrate medium and concept to shape meaning for particular purposes and audiences
EE1-11-06 analyses choices in textual form and language, and their influence on the crafting of texts	EE1-12-06 analyses choices in textual form and language, and their influence on the crafting of texts	EE2-12-06 examines and evaluates the ways literary debates influence compositional processes and choices

Outcomes and content for Year 11

Texts, culture and value

Outcomes

A student:

- analyses the relationship between author, purpose, form, language, audience and context **EE1-11-01**
- analyses the ways meaning is made through an author's choice of textual form and language features **EE1-11-02**
- analyses how texts are valued in a range of contexts and cultures for different purposes and audiences **EE1-11-03**
- uses independent inquiry skills to analyse key texts and compose texts **EE1-11-04**
- crafts extended texts that experiment with textual form and language features for a range of purposes and audiences **EE1-11-05**
- analyses choices in textual form and language, and their influence on the crafting of texts **EE1-11-06**

Content

Students examine a key text from the past and its manifestations in a range of texts from more recent social, [cultural](#) and historical [contexts](#) to explore how and why texts reflect and challenge cultural values over time. They explore, analyse and critically evaluate different examples of such texts in a range of [forms](#) and media, including texts of their choice.

Students critically analyse and interpret how the content, [language](#), form and [style](#) of texts are influenced by aspects of context, and how these elements communicate [values](#) and attitudes. They evaluate the ways in which aspects of texts from the past can be carried forward, borrowed from and appropriated, and examine how the value of texts is renegotiated by [audiences](#) over time.

Related research project

Students complete a Related research project that provides opportunities for them to develop skills in independent investigation and [critical](#) and creative thinking. Students apply the skills and conceptual understanding developed in Texts, culture and value to the investigation of their own selected texts. They develop an understanding of research skills and practices to support their interpretive, analytical and imaginative responses to texts.

Students select a key text from the past and examine and evaluate manifestations of their selected text in other contexts and media while considering how and whether the values embedded in one text parallel, challenge or offer alternatives to the other. They [synthesise](#) their research and communicate their understanding in an original composition, manipulating form for purpose and experimenting with [language](#) features to shape meaning. The project may be undertaken concurrently with their study of Texts, culture and value.

Understanding

- The relationship between text, author, reader and context, and the ways they shape meaning
- The relationship between a text and the culture it is [composed](#) in and responded to
- The ways texts are appropriated or manifested in a range of social, historical and cultural contexts
- The ways values are shaped in and through texts
- The ways that textual forms, language and stylistic choices shape meaning

- Intertextual connections that offer multiple interpretations
- Sophisticated metalanguage in textual analysis and [reflection](#)

Responding

- Craft texts that experiment with traditional and emerging literary forms in familiar or new contexts
- Craft arguments that support critical interpretations with textual analysis
- Craft texts that re-imagine and re-create other texts, experimenting with [perspective](#), point of view, style and context to show how values are maintained and changed
- Craft reflective texts that evaluate and assess the influence of stylistic choices on meaning
- Craft critical and creative texts that demonstrate skills in research methodology and independent investigation

Outcomes and content for Year 12 – Extension 1

Literary worlds

Outcomes

A student:

- evaluates the relationship between author, purpose, form, language, audience and context **EE1-12-01**
- evaluates the ways meaning is made through an author's choice of textual form and language features **EE1-12-02**
- analyses how texts are valued in a range of contexts and cultures for different purposes and audiences **EE1-12-03**
- uses independent inquiry skills to analyse key texts and compose complex texts **EE1-12-04**
- crafts extended texts that experiment with textual form and language features for a range of purposes and audiences **EE1-12-05**
- analyses choices in textual form and language, and their influence on the crafting of texts **EE1-12-06**

Content

Literary worlds are textual creations of imagination through which a complex relationship is established between author, reader and text. Literary worlds are the [narrative representations](#) of people and events; they transcend time and space, and offer depictions that are realistic or metaphoric, possible or fictional, public or private. Students engage with, interpret and experiment with the complex relationship between texts, authors, readers and [contexts](#). They explore a range of short texts and extracts from larger works that construct literary worlds.

Students evaluate a range of texts that construct literary worlds. They deepen their understanding of the ideas and ways of thinking represented in texts and how these are shaped by textual [forms](#) and [language](#) features. Students consider aspects of personal, social, [cultural](#) and historical contexts in their responses to, and compositions of, literary worlds. They examine the ways literary worlds can affirm or challenge their own [values](#) and their assumptions about, and experiences of, the ways texts make meaning.

In their study of literary worlds, students experiment with [critical](#) and creative compositions. They communicate their understanding of the ways literary worlds are constructed to express complex ideas and emotions, motivations, attitudes, experiences and values. These compositions may be realised in various forms, [modes](#) and mediums.

Each elective in this focus area involves the study of THREE texts from the prescribed list, with at least TWO of these texts required to be extended print texts, which may include poetry.

Students are also required to study ONE related text for the elective.

Understanding

- The aesthetic qualities of language and the ways they shape meaning and communicate values
- Changing contexts and values, and how they influence the ways meaning is made
- A range of critical [perspectives](#) that shape personal responses to complex texts
- Social, historical and personal values in texts, and how they shape meaning and influence responses

Responding

- Craft extended texts in a variety of modes and mediums to communicate an understanding of evolving literary [conventions](#) and [genres](#)
- Craft original texts that experiment with and manipulate textual form and stylistic features to shape meaning and present informed perspectives
- Craft [sustained](#) arguments that [synthesise](#) a range of critical perspectives about a text's cultural assumptions and values, informed by analysis of textual evidence
- Craft texts that reflect on stylistic and language choices to represent the complex relationship between texts, authors, readers and contexts
- Use sophisticated and controlled language with clarity to express informed perspectives

Outcomes and content for Year 12 – Extension 2

Author and authority

Outcomes

A student:

- evaluates the relationship between author, purpose, form, language, audience and context **EE2-12-01**
- communicates insights and arguments about an area of literary inquiry or debate **EE2-12-02**
- evaluates the ways meaning and value can be assigned to authors and texts **EE2-12-03**
- creates sustained critical and creative texts supported by independent inquiry and scholarly readings **EE2-12-04**
- creates sustained texts that integrate medium and concept to shape meaning for particular purposes and audiences **EE2-12-05**
- examines and evaluates the ways literary debates influence compositional processes and choices **EE2-12-06**

Content

Students learn about how and why the ways we [create](#) and read literature have changed over time and evaluate the relationship between texts and literary criticism. They engage with significant literary thinkers and texts to understand the role that they play in a broader literary [context](#).

Students evaluate literary originality and how innovation has shaped new ways of representing meaning. They interrogate how [genre](#), technology and [form](#) can reassign and redistribute [authority](#) over a text and question the primacy of the author.

Students explore a range of short texts from the past and the contemporary era, and extracts from larger works that experiment with [perspective](#) and form, to evaluate the nature of literary texts and develop a theoretical understanding of the role of the author. They evaluate the changing perceptions of authorship and authority in a range of literary contexts.

Students develop their knowledge of the author's role in the emergence of new textual forms to evaluate the extent to which an author's manipulation of form reflects and shapes its context.

Author study

Students develop their understanding of author and authority by exploring ONE author study. In their author study, students evaluate the primacy of the author in creating a text's meaning. Students will develop an understanding of the roles of the author and reader as reproducers of ideas, [language](#) and texts that are part of a broader literary and theoretical context. They develop their understanding of significant thinkers, theories and movements by exploring an author study.

Students apply their knowledge and understanding of author and authority in their own [critical](#) and creative compositions. They experiment with perspective, point of view and voice to explore the interrelationship between content, purpose, form and [audience](#). As creators of texts, they reflect on the composition process to consider how their creative choices shape meaning.

Author and authority can be undertaken concurrently with the development of their Major work.

Understanding

- The ways significant texts generate ideas and develop knowledge of authorship and aesthetics

- The ways that text, author, reader, context and criticism interact and shape an author's reception over time and in a range of contexts
- The ways complex and interconnected textual forms, language features and structures, can represent sophisticated ideas

Responding

- Craft extended texts to explain, argue, analyse and evaluate ideas and perspectives
- Craft sophisticated and original texts with precision to develop and communicate complex ideas, perspectives and arguments
- Craft texts that evaluate the different ways texts are valued and received
- Craft texts using language and structural choices appropriate to context, audience and purpose
- Use appropriate academic language in the analysis and evaluation of texts

Major work

Outcomes

A student:

- evaluates the relationship between author, purpose, form, language, audience and context **EE2-12-01**
- communicates insights and arguments about an area of literary inquiry or debate **EE2-12-02**
- evaluates the ways meaning and value can be assigned to authors and texts **EE2-12-03**
- creates sustained critical and creative texts supported by independent inquiry and scholarly readings **EE2-12-04**
- creates sustained texts that integrate medium and concept to shape meaning for particular purposes and audiences **EE2-12-05**
- examines and evaluates the ways literary debates influence compositional processes and choices **EE2-12-06**

Content

The Major work is a [sustained](#), cohesive and extended composition that demonstrates mastery of the composition process. Students engage in extensive investigation of a literary subject of their own choosing to evaluate the ways their own creative or [critical](#) composition is situated within an established literary and theoretical [context](#).

Author and [authority](#) develops their knowledge of literary criticism to support the development of their own independent inquiry. This knowledge supports students to purposefully experiment with textual [form](#) and [language](#) features in their own critical or creative compositions. The Major work is an opportunity for students to consider authority in their own text through the dynamic relationship between author, purpose, form, language, [audience](#) and context.

A Major work communicates an idea that is conceptually insightful and thought-provoking, with a clear sense of purpose, audience and context appropriate to the chosen form and [style](#).

Students engage in the extensive investigation of a concept and medium of their own choosing to extend the knowledge and skills developed in their Stage 6 English courses and Author and authority.

The concept and medium of the Major work should contribute to the authority, originality and overall literary purpose of the work. As part of their composition, students purposefully manipulate and control the language features and [conventions](#) of their chosen form to support the content of their composition. The work should demonstrate a conscious and purposeful style that has been refined to ensure artistry and [textual integrity](#).

Throughout the development of the Major work, students evaluate and reflect on their research and composition processes, using a range of [modes](#) and mediums in their Major work journal.

Understanding

- The complex relationship between text, author, reader and context
- Complex and interconnected language forms, language features and structures that shape meaning
- The ways context shapes the value, audience and reception of their composition
- The ways scholarly texts, academic readings and literary debates can refine and test original ideas

- The ways research methodology supports independent inquiry in the creation of an extended composition

Responding

- Craft texts in a range of modes and mediums that evaluate ideas and [perspectives](#)
- Craft texts that purposefully experiment with and manipulate textual form and language to shape meaning
- Craft texts that justify choices of mode and medium, based on the relationship between purpose, audience and context
- Craft texts that make reflective judgements on creative and critical choices of concept and style in the Major work
- [Create](#) an independent composition underpinned by targeted extensive research into concept and form
- Use appropriate academic language, including metalanguage, in the analysis and evaluation of strategically chosen texts and their influence on the Major work
- Use their Major work journal to record, develop and [critique](#) the influence of texts, perspectives and ideas